

Paul Denteh

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SUMMARY

Detail-oriented cybersecurity professional with hands-on experience in SOC operations, IAM, and cloud environments. Proven ability to triage security alerts, investigate incidents, and implement identity-centric controls across enterprise systems. Strong background in SIEM, EDR, vulnerability management, and Okta IAM, combined with effective communication, cross-functional collaboration, and strong documentation skills in fast-paced, regulated environments.

EDUCATION

University of South Florida

May 2025

Master of Science, Computer Science

Ghana Communication Technology University

May 2020

Bsc, Computer Engineering

EXPERIENCE

Community Dreams Foundation

May 2025 - Present

Cybersecurity Analyst

Sebring, FL

- Monitor and analyze alerts from enterprise security and detection platforms (XDR, EDR, IDS/IPS), applying structured triage methods to distinguish false positives from real incidents.
- Assist in updating security policies, procedures, and incident documentation to comply with ISO 27001, NIST 800, and ISO/IEC 27002 frameworks.
- Conduct security assessments, report vulnerabilities, and ensure systems remain compliant with industry standards.
- Participating in security awareness and phishing simulations, strengthening employee cybersecurity practices.
- Applying OWASP Top 10 and CWE standards to guide secure development and mitigate application risks.

EFT Corporation

Aug 2020 - Sep 2023

Payment Systems Engineer

Accra, Ghana

- Led design and development of RESTful API integrations between merchant platforms and the ACI payment switch for Visa and MasterCard transactions, ensuring scalable and robust solutions.
- Administered Thales HSMs and automated cryptographic key management policies using bash and Python, aligning procedures with PCI-DSS requirements.
- Served as a consultative partner for e-commerce and POS merchants, guiding clients through integration processes and translating business workflows into technical solutions.
- Collaborated with Sales, Account Managers, and Engineering to conduct backup validations, failover simulations, and DR testing in VM-based environments, driving continuous improvements in platform resilience.

PROJECTS

Enterprise SSO Integration (OIDC, SAML & MFA) | [Live Demo](#) | [Github](#)

- Implemented Okta-based Single Sign-On using OIDC, SAML and Google OAuth as an additional identity provider.
- Built custom Django authentication flows supporting **SAML assertions** and the **OIDC authorization code flow**, including secure session Management
- Integrated authentication state into a protected SOC-style dashboard with role-aware access control and centralized logout
- Configured Okta Identity Provider (IdP) settings, authentication policies, MFA enforcement, user assignments, and authorization server access policies.

System Security Hardening & Vulnerability Management | [Github](#)

- Configured and executed vulnerability assessments with Nessus on Windows systems, identifying and analyzing critical security weaknesses.
- Prepared and delivered comprehensive vulnerability reports with actionable recommendations to strengthen overall security posture.
- Deployed testing tools and implemented remediation strategies, applying system hardening and robust security controls to reduce risk exposure.
- **Self-Hosted Password Manager on AWS Cloud** | [Github](#)
- Designed and deployed a self-hosted password management system on AWS with a focus on secure cloud architecture.
- Implemented HTTPS/TLS encryption and IAM-based access controls to protect sensitive credentials.
- Applied cloud security best practices to support system reliability, scalability, and data protection.

SKILLS

- **Programming & Automation:** Python, Linux, PowerShell, Bash, SQL, C/C++, Java.
- **Security & IAM:** SIEM (Splunk), EDR/XDR, Log Analysis, Alert Triage, Access Provisioning, Vulnerability Management, Threat Intelligence, OWASP Top 10, CWE, SailPoint, Authentication & Authorization.
- **Security Tools:** Splunk, Nessus, Wireshark, Burp Suite, Snort, Hydra, OSINT Tools, nmap, VirusTotal, Metasploit.
- **Payment:** EMV(Chip & PIN) , CNP, 3D Secure, PCI-DSS compliance, ISO 8583, Tokenization and Encryption, NFC payments.
- **Networking & Infrastructure:** TCP/IP, DNS, VPN, Active Directory, Firewalls.
- **Operating Systems:** Windows, Linux, macOS.
- **Collaboration & Ticketing:** Jira, ServiceNow, Salesforce
- **Certifications:** CompTIA Security+, CEH, CCNA Routing & Switching, CCNA Intro to Networks, Microsoft Azure fundamentals.